

win big. Because there are millions and millions of 8-hour workers, but relatively few 12-hour workers.

The statistics we found show that married men earn 11 percent more than their unmarried counterparts, and that the gap widens as they age.³ This is consistent with our hypothesis. But it is far from the proof we would like to see. We believe that specialization, concentration, and accumulation pay off in a spectacular way—a lot more than 11 percent per year. In our ideal wealth-building family, the husband works like a dog—outside the home. The wife works, too, but inside the household, freeing the husband to concentrate on building wealth without undermining the integrity of the family itself.

Even working 12 hours per day and focusing almost exclusively on building a successful business, there are no guarantees. We recall from our own experience that it was a close run, with critical advances made by partners, associates and employees just in the nick of time.

COMPOUND EFFORT OVER TIME

You’ve heard of the “miracle of compound interest.” Well, there’s a similar miracle at work in the rest of life. . . .

One of the boys, 23, called recently. “I’m about ready to give up,” he said.

The young man graduated from college two years ago. He could have easily entered the family business. Instead, he decided to try to make his career in one of the world’s most difficult *métiers*, as a singer/musician/songwriter.

He moved to Brooklyn, which seems to attract young musicians like London attracts fund managers. He took courses at Juilliard. He wrote songs. He put them on the Internet. He sang at “open mic” nights in clubs and bars.

But after six months, it didn’t seem to be going anywhere.

Meanwhile, his sister voiced similar disappointment and impatience.